Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

- **South African banks could lose their grip on fintech payments** — TechCabal, 26 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  The South African Reserve Bank plans to publish by end-November 2026 an authorisation framework letting approved non-banks issue e-money, process merchant payments and reach clearing and settlement directly, without a sponsor bank. TechCabal weighs what that does to the fees banks earn from fintechs. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech.*

Data protection

- **Protection of personal privacy and rights is central to NDPC's mandate – Olatunji** — BusinessDay, 26 October 2026 NIGERIA

  In a BusinessDay interview, NDPC chief executive Vincent Olatunji describes building Nigeria's data protection commission since 2022 and the personal and sensitive data it regulates, with trust and accountability for AI as its next concern.

Regional collaboration

- **West Africa Struggles to Deliver Free Roaming Nearly Nine Years After Regional Agreement - Ecofin Agency** — Ecofin Agency, 26 October 2026 WEST AFRICA

  Burkina Faso's roaming agreements with Benin, Côte d'Ivoire and Senegal need about three months of operator work before they take effect, nearly nine years after ECOWAS adopted regional roaming rules. WATRA had counted 13 bilateral agreements across eight countries by August 2025. *Also under Connectivity.*

- **NBC, BEAC ink MoU on financial cooperation framework** — Khmer Times, 26 October 2026 CENTRAL AFRICA

  BEAC signed a memorandum of understanding with the National Bank of Cambodia in Phnom Penh, with a 2027-2028 action plan on digital transformation, financial inclusion and cybersecurity. It covers interconnecting payment systems, potentially linking Cambodia's Bakong with the CEMAC region. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech.*

- **FINAL COMMUNIQUÉ OF THE TWENTY FIFTH SUMMIT OF THE COMESA AUTHORITY OF HEADS OF STATE AND GOVERNMENT** — COMESA, 26 October 2026 AFRICA

  The 25th COMESA Summit in Harare on 22 October 2026 urged member states to support the Digital Retail Payment Platform after its Malawi-Zambia pilot, and noted the electronic certificate of origin live in six states. It called for faster national single windows and trade portals. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech, Data Exchange and Connectivity.*

Standards

- **The data centre inquiry is really a test of King V** — ITWeb Africa, 26 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  An ITWeb column argues that the Human Rights Commission's data centre inquiry also binds companies that lease capacity, through the King V governance code in force since January 2026. It notes that Africa Data Centres sought retrospective environmental authorisation at its Midrand campus after an expansion. *Also under Data Storage and Public debate and participation in policymaking.*

Public debate and participation in policymaking

- **DREW HALLER | Millions risk exclusion as Smart ID delays persist** — Business Day, 26 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  A Business Day column warns that about 4 million undocumented South Africans risk being unable to vote on 4 November, while 341,000 Smart IDs lie unclaimed. It weighs the digital ID plan and the MyMzanzi app trial against that exclusion. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS.*

- **The data centre inquiry is really a test of King V** — ITWeb Africa, 26 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Summarised under Standards.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **Maroc Telecom Group Revenue Rises 5.1% to MAD 28.68 Billion in Q3 2026** — Tech Africa News, 26 October 2026 MOROCCO

  Maroc Telecom's group revenue rose 5.1% to MAD 28.68bn in the nine months to September 2026, with the Moov Africa subsidiaries up 6.9%. Mobile money revenue at the subsidiaries grew 18.8%. *Also under ICT Industry and Digital Payments and Fintech.*

- **Ethio Telecom Extends 4G LTE Coverage to 80 More Towns** — Tech Africa News, 26 October 2026 ETHIOPIA

  Ethio telecom extended 4G LTE to 80 more Ethiopian towns. Its 2026/27 plan targets 4G population coverage of 95%, from 82.23%, across 1,500 towns. *Also under Access to services.*

- **West Africa Struggles to Deliver Free Roaming Nearly Nine Years After Regional Agreement - Ecofin Agency** — Ecofin Agency, 26 October 2026 WEST AFRICA

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Data Storage

- **Nigeria to get two new AI-ready data centres in a $1 billion investment** — TechCabal, 26 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Infragora Global Capital plans to start building two AI-ready AFRIDATA data centres in Nigeria in the second and third quarters of 2027, a project it puts at $650 million to $1 billion, with financial close still to come. The centres would run on a dedicated 160-200 MW gas, renewable and battery plant. *Also under Energy and US / hyperscaler activities.*

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Energy

- **Nigeria to get two new AI-ready data centres in a $1 billion investment** — TechCabal, 26 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Summarised under Data Storage.

Cybersecurity

- **Rwanda cyber authority boosts security with Airtel, MTN** — Connecting Africa, 26 October 2026 RWANDA

  Rwanda's National Cyber Security Authority partnered with Airtel Rwanda to support the University of Rwanda's CyberHub with student internships, alongside an MoU with MTN Rwanda. No value or term was stated. *Also under Training and skills*.

DPI

Data Exchange

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  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

Digital Identity and CRVS

- **Mozambique: Centro Pronto document application service to expand to diaspora** — Club of Mozambique, 26 October 2026 MOZAMBIQUE

  Mozambique plans to open Centro Pronto document-application centres for the diaspora in Cape Town, Porto and England within six months, through its partnership with VFS. The state keeps the technology, data collection and document validation. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov*.

- **Minister hails 'Home Affairs @home' milestone** — TimesLIVE (Sunday Times), 26 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Minister Leon Schreiber hailed more than one million replacement Smart ID applications at bank branches through Home Affairs @home in seven months. Passport and first-time ID applications with home delivery are to follow at over 1,000 branches.

- **Home Affairs milestone on one million Smart IDs delivered in seven months** — South African Government (Department of Home Affairs), 26 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Home Affairs says 1,002,773 South Africans have applied for replacement Smart IDs at 669 bank branches in just over seven months, a fully digital, biometric process, with passports, first-time IDs and home delivery to follow. The green ID book stops being produced on 31 March 2027 and loses validity a year later. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov*.

- **DREW HALLER | Millions risk exclusion as Smart ID delays persist** — Business Day, 26 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Summarised under Public debate and participation in policymaking.

Digital Payments and Fintech

- **EBANX Integrates OPay Direct Debit for Global Subscription Payments in Nigeria** — Tech Africa News, 26 October 2026 NIGERIA

  EBANX became the first international payments provider to offer OPay Direct Debit, so global subscription merchants can collect recurring payments from Nigerian consumers through the OPay wallet. OPay claims 40 million monthly active users. *Also under ICT Industry*.

- **Airtel Money Revenue Rises 34% to $830 Million in First Half of FY2027** — Tech Africa News, 26 October 2026 AFRICA

  Airtel Money reported revenue up 34% to $830 million for the half year to 30 September 2026, its first results as a listed company, with customers up 18.7% to 56.7 million. Annualised processed value reached $270 billion in the second quarter. *Also under ICT Industry*.

- **Airtel Mobile Commerce N.V., Results for the half year ended 30 September 2026** — Airtel Mobile Commerce N.V. (Airtel Money), 26 October 2026 AFRICA

  Airtel Money's own results announcement for the half year to 30 September 2026, its first as a listed company, reports 56.7 million customers, mobile money penetration of 42.9% of Airtel's telecom base and annualised processed value of $270 billion. It declared an interim dividend of 6.4 US cents a share. *Also under ICT Industry*.

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  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

Sectoral management information systems

- **Du contenu à la gestion : Madagascar accélère la numérisation de son système éducatif** — wearetech.africa, 26 October 2026 MADAGASCAR

  Madagascar's digital development ministry launched MPIANATRA, a school-management platform for tracking pupils' progress, on 24 October 2026; its deployment in public schools is still to be studied. It follows the NUIS single pupil identifier, piloted with about 180,000 pupils since May.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

- **The brutal financial reality behind government AI adoption in Africa** — TechCabal, 26 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA NIGERIA KENYA AFRICA

TechCabal argues that African governments' demand for AI does not yet make a market for local startups, citing a South African CIPC chatbot tender that pays only after delivery and a GIZ-Briter survey in which 44% of AI businesses target governments. It notes that Nigeria's N-ATLAS project discloses neither the contract's value nor its payment terms. *Also under AI and ICT Industry.*

- **Fonction publique : 5,38 milliards de FCFA pour accélérer la modernisation en 2027** — GabonReview, 26 October 2026 GABON

  Gabon's civil-service ministry asked parliament for FCFA 5.38bn for 2027, excluding staff costs, to digitise five procedures, bring 150 processing stations into service and deploy the SIGRH human-resources system. Only 32% of its 2026 envelope had been executed by end-October.

- **Mozambique: Centro Pronto document application service to expand to diaspora** — Club of Mozambique, 26 October 2026 MOZAMBIQUE

  Summarised under Digital Identity and CRVS.

- **Home Affairs milestone on one million Smart IDs delivered in seven months** — South African Government (Department of Home Affairs), 26 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

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Technology

AI

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ICT Industry

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Capacity

Training and skills

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  Summarised under Cybersecurity.

Inclusion

Access to services

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  Summarised under Connectivity.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

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ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country and region news.